Beginning Well

BIBL 220

BIBLICAL THEOLOGY

Goals of the Course

Consider Deeply

- Nature of Reality
- Overall Concerns of Scripture

Importance:

- Lifelong impact

Practice principles of interpretation

Strategies for the Course

On Your Own

Reading:

Genesis 1-11 as a Basis for Biblical Theology

Assignments:

- Quizzes (official in Canvas, practice in KHP)
- Three Reflection Papers

In Class

- Validate and discuss ideas from textbook
- Discuss real life impact
- Journaling (included as reflection papers)

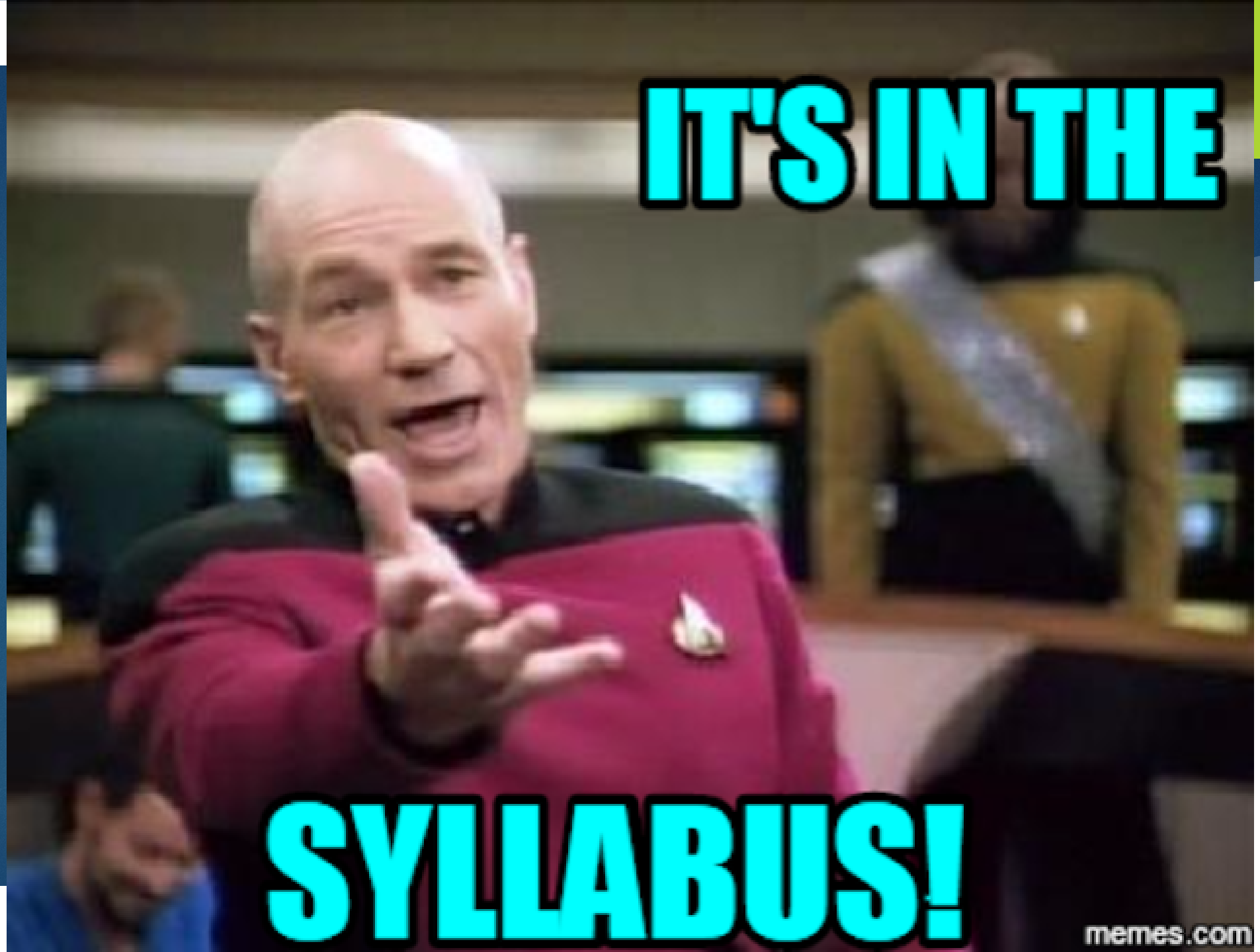
Classroom Time

Classroom Discussion

- Bring journals & pens/pencils
- Bring computers with Accordance
  - 1/27 and afterwards
- Active participation is critical
- Try not to be insecure or sensitive

Classroom Protocol

- Try not to be late
- No texting
- No side conversations
- Prayer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Theology

Systematic or Biblical?

What is Theology?

- *Theos* (God) + *Logos* (word)
- The study of God in general
  - Approaches
    - Religions and their sacred texts
    - History and development of religious ideas
    - Philosophy
  - Primary religions studying theology
    - Jewish
    - Muslim
    - Christianity

What is Theology?

- Theological Studies within Christianity
  - Comparative Religion
    - Histories
    - Beliefs
    - Sacred Texts *(e.g., Quran vs. The Bible)*
  - The Bible
    - As a religious text
    - As truth

What is Christian Theology?

- Christian Theology as a study of truth
  - Systematic Theology
  - Biblical Theology

What is *Systematic* Theology?

- Topics
  - Prolegomena (sources of revelation)
  - Theology Proper (God)
  - Christology (Jesus)
  - Pneumatology (the Holy Spirit)
  - Anthropology (humanity)
  - Hamartiology (sin)
  - Soteriology (salvation)
  - Ecclesiology (the Church)
  - Eschatology (end times)

What is *Systematic* Theology?

- What drives systematic theology?
  - Questions that arise within culture
    - the nature of God
    - the nature of Christ
    - organizational structure of the church
    - end time events
    - spiritual gifts
    - women in ministry

What is *Systematic* Theology?

- Problems
  - Topics are commonly not ***explicitly*** addressed in the Bible
  - Topics chosen based on interest and cultural issues
  - Tendency to take Scripture out of context *(poor exegesis)*
  - Tendency to prooftext *(using Scripture to affirm our ideas)*
  - Tendency to harmonize *(rationalizing things not understood)*
  - Tendency to use as interpretive grids *(what WE believe)*
    - Calvinism
    - Dispensationalism
    - Pentecostalism
    - *etc.*

What is *Biblical* Theology?

- Attempts to take the Bible on its on terms
  - Looks at topics that the Bible explicitly discusses
    - Faith
    - Worship
    - Evangelism
    - Covenants
    - Kingdom of God
    - Future of Israel
    - *etc.*

What is *Biblical* Theology?

- Advantages
  - Reduces the problems associated with systematic theology
    - Doesn’t create topics that the Bible doesn’t discuss
    - Eliminates prooftexting and taking things out of context
    - Reduces tendency to harmonize by accepting tension
    - Reduces tendency to say more than the Bible says
    - Solidly based on exegesis

What is *Biblical* Theology?

- Problems
  - ***In practice***, it still chooses which topics are primary
  - Attempts to suggest prioritizing topics
    - Providence/election
    - Law and Promise
    - Covenant
    - Rule of God
    - Kingdom of God
    - Presence and action of God
    - God's design
    - Salvation story

True Biblical Theology

- Allows Scripture to determine the topics
- Allows Scripture to prioritize its own topics
- Accepts and doesn't try to explain "tension"
- Focuses on the specific theology presented by the author

True Biblical Theology

- Suggestion in this course:
  - Genesis 1-11
    - actually does choose the primary topics
    - gives an order of priority
    - presents the principles that govern all existence
    - presents the principles that are developed throughout the rest of Scripture.

Hermeneutical Method

- Principles learned in BIBL 200
- Focus on authorial intentions
- Not simply academic analysis
  - Place ourselves ***under*** rather than ***over*** Scripture.
  - Quiet meditation before the Lord